

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

2000-07-20

To the friends gathered at the Asian international

1 karachi, pakistan, 21–23 july 2000

2 dear bahá'í friends,

3 we send our loving greetings to the friends gathered at the international

4 bahá'í youth conference held in karachi at this central stage of the Twelve

5 month plan.

our confident hope is that the youth, both in pakistan and throughout

6 Asia, will increasingly be one of the strongest instruments in advancing

7 the process of entry by troops. for this to happen, bahá'í youth, like all

8 bahá'ís, need to fortify their faith by immersing themselves repeatedly and

frequently in the study of the creative word of god. one of the major

9 purposes of training institutes is to help make this enrichment possible. our

10 hope is that great numbers of youth will not only participate in the courses

11 of the institutes, but will themselves assume the responsibilities of tutors

12 and facilitators. Such a development will serve both bahá'ís and the wider

13 society in your countries.

14 Now that the knowledge of the name of the faith has spread widely,

15 and ever more people are becoming aware of its Teachings, the public in many places
is watching the bahá'í community to see how these life-giving

16 principles of bahá'u'lláh are affecting the daily lives of his followers. The

17 verities of the faith must become increasingly demonstrated in the way its

18 adherents serve humanity, champion justice and promote unity. in a letter

19 written to a National Spiritual Assembly on his behalf shortly before his passing the
beloved guardian explained:

The bahá'ís are the leaven of god, which must leaven the lump of

their nation. in direct ratio to their success will be the protection

vouchsafed, not only to them but to their country. These are the im-

20 mutable laws of god, from which there is no escape. . . .

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339 m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e

340 72The challenge facing you at this important gathering is to consider how

341 you can become this leaven, an example to masses of people who are des-

342 perately seeking somewhere to turn for spiritual help.

As you are aware, the T twelve month plan emphasizes the importance

343 of the bahá'í education of children and junior youth. youth, who are so

344 often the role models of their younger siblings and friends, have a unique
opportunity in this regard. in responding to this opportunity, you will be

345 astonished how you yourselves will be enriched.

As you consult together over the next few days, drawing upon the wis-

346 dom and experience of counselors vicente Samaniego and rosalie T ran,

347 you may be sure that our prayers will be surrounding you.

348 with loving b ahá'í greetings,

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Message to the Youth Conference

in Vancouver, Canada

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]